

Matthieu Chaldebas

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PROFILE

PhD Computational Biologist and Machine Learning Scientist with 5+ years of experience engineering predictive models for genome-wide variant prioritization and target discovery. Proven track record of translating high-dimensional genomic data into mechanistic disease insights, with 13 publications including Nature, PNAS, and first-author in AJHG.

EXPERIENCE

PhD Researcher

2021 – Present

St. Giles Laboratory of Human Genetics of Infectious Diseases, The Rockefeller University, New York, NY

- **Engineered and deployed 5ULTRA**, a novel Python-based ML framework combining SpliceAI, uORF databases, and a Random Forest classifier to prioritize 5'UTR variants genome-wide (Published 1st author in AJHG, 2026).
- **Improved predictive accuracy** over the industry standard (CADD v1.7) by achieving an AUC of 0.82 vs. 0.75 on independent ClinVar 5'UTR variants benchmarks.
- **Pioneered rare 5'UTR variant burden testing at population scale**, analyzing 490,000 UK Biobank genomes across 59 quantitative traits.
- **Discovered 18 gene-phenotype associations** (including *NELFCD* for platelet distribution width) entirely missed by standard models, yielding a 1.6× increase in genome-wide significant discoveries over the CADD framework (58 vs. 37).
- **Demonstrated translational dosage rheostats** in human genetics, proving that 5'UTR hypomorphic variation yields burden effects quantitatively comparable to exome protein-truncating variants (PTVs).
- **Validated in-silico predictions** using large-scale Olink proteomics (n = 46,362) and MPRA readouts, proving identified cis-pQTL variants carry effect sizes >5x larger than baseline.
- **Orchestrated high-throughput WES/WGS pipelines** of 26,000+ patient samples, directly supporting computational analyses for 10 high-impact publications (Nature, PNAS, Immunity).

Data Scientist Intern

6 months, 2021

BioMérieux, Lyon, France

- **Developed supervised Lasso ML models** for antibiotic resistance prediction, extending cross-validation techniques to successfully account for complex phylogenetic structures.
- **Implemented novelty detection algorithms** to clean and standardize heterogeneous clinical datasets, improving the reliability and accuracy of downstream model predictions.

EDUCATION

PhD Candidate, Bioinformatics

2022 – Dec 2026 (Expected)

Université Paris Cité - Research at The Rockefeller University, St. Giles Lab.

Advisors: Drs. Casanova, Cobat & Zhang

MS, Biotechnology Engineering

2016 – 2021

Sup'Biotech, Paris, France

Exchange Semester: Immunology & Human Disease

2018

UC San Diego, La Jolla, CA

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS (13 TOTAL)

- Chaldebas M, Ponsin K, Bohlen J, et al. (2026). **Genome-wide detection of human 5'UTR variants that impact protein translation.** *The American Journal of Human Genetics* 113(4), 809–827.
- Chaldebas M, Casanova JL, Zhang P, et al. (in prep). **Mechanistic 5'UTR variant scoring expands rare-variant discovery in the UK Biobank.** *Manuscript in preparation*
- Zhang P, Chaldebas M, Ogishi M, et al. (2023). **Genome-wide detection of human intronic AG-gain variants.** *PNAS* 120(46), e2314225120.
- Arias AA, Neehus AL, et al. [incl. Chaldebas M] (2024). **Tuberculosis in otherwise healthy adults with inherited TNF deficiency.** *Nature* 633(8029), 417–425.
- Ogishi M, Kitaoka K, et al. [incl. Chaldebas M] (2024). **Impaired development of memory B cells in humans deficient in PD-1 signaling.** *Immunity* 57(12), 2790–2807.
- Chan YH, Liu Z, et al. [incl. Chaldebas M] (2024). **Human TMEFF1 is a restriction factor for herpes simplex virus in the brain.** *Nature* 632(8024), 390–400.
- Matuozzo D, Talouarn E, et al. [incl. Chaldebas M] (2023). **Rare predicted loss-of-function variants of type I IFN immunity genes are associated with life-threatening COVID-19.** *Genome medicine* 15(1), 22.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Core Competencies: Machine Learning & Predictive Modeling, Population-Scale Genomics (WGS), Multi-Omics Integration, Target Identification, High-Performance Computing (HPC), Statistical Genetics

Programming: Python (primary), R, Bash

ML & Modeling: Scikit-learn, Random Forest, Lasso, SMOTE, feature engineering; AlphaGenome & Alphafold integration

Genomics & Statistics: Rare-variant burden testing (REGENIE), scRNA-seq, bulk RNA-seq, pQTL/proteomics (Olink), GWAS, 5'UTR biology, SpliceAI, gnomAD, UK Biobank, ClinVar, COSMIC

Infrastructure: Linux, Snakemake, Docker, Git, SLURM, DNAnexus, UKB RAP

Languages: French (native), English (fluent — TOEIC 975/990)

VISA & ELIGIBILITY

J-1 visa (no 212e bar); 3 years H-1B eligibility remaining.